

Samsung Galaxy Book 4 Pro

Sleek, Portable And Capable

Samsung's previous attempt at making a thin and light laptop was very

successful. However, as is the case with all Windows laptops, OEMs can only work with the CPUs that chip makers have on offer. While last year's model was fairly good, it was not particularly competitive in terms of performance. At the beginning of this year, Intel released its Core Ultra chips, pushing the X86 architecture forward in both form and function.

So the question remains: How good is the Samsung Galaxy Book 4 Pro in 2024? Given that it has been a few months since the chip's launch, does it hold up well against the likes of Qualcomm's Snapdragon X Elite and AMD Ryzen AI 9 HX 370? Here's the answer.

DESIGN, BUILD QUALITY, KEYBOARD AND I/O

First up, the fit and finish of the laptop are meticulous, with smooth edges and well-integrated components, reflecting high-quality craftsmanship. The use of aluminium in the chassis gives the Galaxy Book 4 Pro a premium and durable feel. Despite its robust build, the laptop remains lightweight, weighing in at around 1.53kg, making it highly portable. The minimalist design also adds to the laptop's visual appeal. Meanwhile, the overall construction remains sturdy, with no noticeable flex in the keyboard deck or screen.

The aluminium surface, while stylish, can attract fingerprints and smudges easily. Some users might find

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the edges of the laptop to be a bit sharp. The laptop also has limited colour options.

When it comes to the Galaxy Book 4 Pro's keyboard, the keys are responsive and well-spaced. The keyboard is also backlit. Additionally,

the keys operate quietly, making them suitable for use in quiet environments such as libraries and meetings without disturbing others. However, some users may find the key travel to be a bit shallow.

The touchpad on the Samsung Galaxy Book 4 Pro is large and offers a smooth surface, making it easy to navigate and perform multi-touch gestures. It is precise and responsive. Moreover, the touchpad provides accurate tracking and using it is a breeze. But since it is so big, some users with big hands could face sensitivity issues.

The Galaxy Book 4 Pro features two Thunderbolt 4 ports, providing high-speed data transfer, charging

capabilities, and the ability to connect multiple 4K displays or a single 8K display. These ports also support USB4. In terms of I/O ports, the laptop has one USB 3.2 Gen 1 Type-A port, which is useful for accessories that require a standard USB connection.

The laptop includes an HDMI 2.1 port, allowing for easy connection to external monitors and TVs for high-resolution video output. For quick file transfers from cameras and other devices, the Galaxy Book 4 Pro has a microSD card slot. A 3.5mm headphone/mic combo jack is available for connecting headphones or external microphones.

SCREEN AND SPEAKERS

The Samsung Galaxy Book 4 Pro 16-inch model has an exceptional OLED touchscreen display. With a resolution of 2880×1800 pixels, this display looks very crisp. It

also has a 120Hz refresh rate which is particularly beneficial for video playback. Although the Book 4 Pro I tested did not have a 36-degree hinge, it did have a touchscreen display. The Galaxy Book 4 Pro's display also supports Samsung's S Pen, but I think it better suits the Book 4 Pro 360 variant.

Among the three laptops, the Samsung Galaxy Book 4 Pro stands out due to its balanced features. It offers a peak brightness of 395 cd/m², and excellent colour accuracy with an average Delta E of 1.1. The ASUS Vivobook S15, with the highest peak brightness at 400 cd/m² and a good Delta E of 1.2. The AMD Zenbook S16, while covering 100% of sRGB and DCI-P3, has the lowest brightness at 312 cd/m² and a less accurate Delta E of 2.8. Overall, the Galaxy Book 4 Pro is the most balanced choice, offering great performance and efficiency.

However, the speakers on the Galaxy Book 4 Pro could use some work. The sound quality falls short when compared to the audio experience provided by Apple's MacBooks. Users who prior-